Affirm: Debrief

Use after discussion. These takeaways explain the reasoning; compare them with your original decision.

Financial Lead — Key Takeaways

- Follow the whole waterfall. Funding decisions affect both income and costs. Explain which lines your choice changes before judging what remains.
- Compare on a common basis. Annual income, loan balances and loan-sale volume measure different things. State the denominator and time horizon behind your comparison.
- Stress-test the tradeoff. Explain what happens to contribution and funding capacity if volume doubles or market conditions change. Name an assumption that would change your decision.

Marketing Lead — Key Takeaways

- Trace growth beyond GMV. Connect your proposed spending to the volume it might generate, the revenue it might earn and the costs that volume would carry.
- Separate observation from explanation. A lower marketing bill alongside higher volume is a pattern to investigate. Identify what evidence would establish the cause and whether it can continue.
- Consider who supplies the volume. Customer and partner mix can affect bargaining power and resilience. Explain how those effects enter your waterfall and what your choice gives up.

Operation Lead — Key Takeaways

- Every subtraction has an owner. Name the process your decision would change, who controls it and how you would measure an improvement.
- Distinguish dollars from rates. A cost can rise in total while falling per transaction or per GMV dollar. State which measure supports your argument and why.
- Test the net effect. Changing one slice may also change revenue, service quality or another cost. Trace those effects through contribution before judging the result.

Tech Lead — Key Takeaways

- Connect the budget to the operation. Technology spending can affect several waterfall lines. Explain the path from a proposed investment or cut to an operating outcome.
- Compare build and buy over time. Consider upfront effort, ongoing fees, control, reliability and dependence on partners. State how those costs behave as usage grows.
- Make the investment testable. Identify the capability your choice develops, the evidence that would show it working and the tradeoff elsewhere in the business.

Account Manager — Key Takeaways

- Trace what each sale keeps after variable costs before recommending growth.
- Different rankings can be defensible. Connect the priorities to evidence and the weekly concept.
- Example allocation: 40/30/20/10 totals 100. Explain your own allocation; priority points are not course-grade points.

Key takeaway

- Read the business model downward: volume → revenue → transaction costs → contribution → operating expenses. Explain whether your decision improves the economics of each unit, spreads a fixed cost, or changes both. State the assumptions behind that explanation.
- At double the volume, what changes in your waterfall — and what evidence would make you reconsider?

Apply to your venture

Draw the money flow for one sale in your venture: customer payment, revenue retained, variable costs, and contribution. Identify a cost assumption to test.

Output: A one-sale economics table for Midterm Section C.

Feedback check

Identify one evidence-backed strength in your explanation and one specific revision. Save the record and use the reflection guide.